Style Guide - November 24, 2024,
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Major Style Guide

Poppin Joe's would benefit from utilizing a major style guide, such as the Associated Press style (AP), in the content associated with its brand. This would ensure consistency in content writing.

Key Points of AP style:

- Numbers: 1-9 are spelled out 10+ use numerals
- Dates: Write out the full month name unless it is used with a date then abbreviate (Jan., Feb., Aug., Sept., Oct., Nov., Dec.)
- Titles: Capitalize formal titles when used before a person's name, lowercase when used after
- State Abbreviations: Standard state abbreviations are used, but some states like Texas and Alaska are not abbreviated

Design Elements

Color

Figure 1:

Figure 1 displays the Poppin Joe's Logo and the colors utilized in it; these include white, yellow, dark yellow, light yellow, dark red, scarlet, red, and brown. These warm-toned colors create a cozy, inviting feeling for the observer. One of the main appeals to Poppin Joe's is that it is a

small family-owned business. By keeping these warm tones present, we reinforce that comfortable feeling. Maintaining consistency is important to leverage brand recognition.

Either white or light yellow can be used for the background in content expression for Poppin Joe's to make the text stand out more. Also, "a light color background is generally preferred because it enhances readability, reduces eye strain, and makes text or images on top of it appear clearer and more prominent, especially when viewing on screens for extended periods."(Shalini Singh).

Typography:

The text should be displayed in a darker color to stand out against the lighter background. The text should be displayed in a dark red color as it stands out the most with the lighter background while still staying in the warm color tone sphere.

The headings should be 1.96 larger than the body text to create contrast. The body should be in a 12-point sans serif font. The subheadings should be smaller than the headings but larger than the body text. Right now, the website has the headings in Ariel 28.5 size font. The body is in 12 size Ariel font, and the subheadings are in 14.5 font. The body and the subheadings can remain the same size, but the headings should be made smaller to 23.5 font.

Bold text should be sparingly so crucial information can be highlighted.
Crucial information includes:

- Headings
- Calls to action
- Important deadlines
- Product Names
- Key Words

By placing these crucial elements in bold, a visual hierarchy is established, and search engines know that this information is important.

Quotes should have quotation marks at the start of the quote and at the end. Body text should be broken up to maximize scanability. "Because lengthy paragraphs make reading and scanning your text harder for readers. Good paragraphs discuss a single, well-defined aspect of the topic at hand. They start with a core sentence and generally shouldn't exceed 200 words." (Yoast).

Logo Usage

The logo should be "between 200-300 pixels wide, with 70px being more suitable for very small applications like email signatures where space is limited"(Looka). The logo should be visible on all website pages. The logo should be on Poppin Joe's products and content and only on Poppin Joe's products and content.

The logo should remain consistent in its shape, colors, and presentation to create brand recognition. The logo is not to be tampered with or used in affiliation with other brands or companies.

Image Guidelines

Quality:
All images should be high quality and related to the written content. All images of product locations or workers should be clearly identifiable to consumers; none of the images should be pixelated, and they should have a high enough resolution that they look clear across various screens.

Resolution: 72 PPI
Format: JPEG

Size:
Images should be fitted to the screen.

Website Logo Size

- Height - 100 pixels
- Width - 250 pixels
  - Aspect ratio - 2:3
  - PPI - 72

Website banner size

- Height - 250 pixels
- Aspect ratio - 1:1
- PPI - 72

- Width - 250 pixels

Captions

All images should be accompanied by a caption and captions should be kept brief if possible. In the figure shown below, there are descriptions of the products that work, but the descriptions are missing the images.

Figure 2:

products

We've been poppin' since 2005 and have learned the Gourmet Kettle Korn flavors our customers love best. We use only the finest quality ingredients to ensure you receive the best tasting Kettle Korn available. And all our Kettle Korn is popped and shipped fresh!

Please call Poppin Joe's™ Kettle Korn at 1-877-360-6929 to place your order. We make the popcorn fresh for each order.

Poppin Joe's™ Gourmet Flavors:

Old-fashioned Kettle Korn – A sweet and salty mixture with just the right crunch.

Cinnamon Kettle Korn – Unmatched, this perfect mild cinnamon taste displays a festive color.

Cheese Kettle Korn – Mild mellow flavor made with a superior white cheddar powder that is produced by a dairy cooperative.

Karamel Korn – An Old Home Recipe with a delicious coating of caramel. It is addicting!

White Cheddar Korn – A delicious cheesy flavor that keeps you coming back for more.

At festivals and events our Old-fashioned Kettle Korn is available in 4 ounce bags for $3 each and 12 ounce bags for $6.00 each.

Local Kansas quick shops and stores carry all of the above products. They can be purchased in 4 ounce and 12 ounce size bags. In addition, during the Holiday Season, we offer beautiful custom tins filled with your favorite Gourmet Kettle Korn flavors.

Contact us to enjoy Poppin Joe's™ Gourmet Kettle Korn at your next event, fundraiser or work function.

Acceptable Content

Images should be current and related to Poppin Joe's in a way that appeals to consumers. Any descriptions of products should be accompanied by images, and those images should accurately portray the products in terms of size and quality. All images of the products should display the logo.

What is on the website here wouldn't be considered acceptable because it isn't an accurate image to display the description below. The image displays the Poppin Joe's product with the logo, but the image doesn't fully encompass the description, and the image seen is the only one on the page.

Writing Guidelines

Brand Voice and Tone

The brand voice is intended to be functional, expressive, and inspirational. Part of the appeal to Poppin Joe's is that it is a small business run by a person who is a member of the DS-ASD community. Younger people want to support affordable small businesses, and people of all ages want to find ways to support DS-ASD in becoming more independent. Poppin Joe's origin story is meant to be inspirational.

Language explaining contact information, how to place an order, etc, is intended to be functional. This language is designed to guide the consumer. Language describing the products is meant to be expressive; the truth about the products is designed to be conveyed in a relevant, interesting way.

How to Refer to Brand

When referring to the brand, repetition of the brand name Poppin Joe's should be used. Logos should be used as well when appropriate. Always be consistent in the spelling and capitalization of the brand name. Be distinctive in the imagery used in regard to the brand. It is important that the brand stands out; there are a lot of places consumers can go to buy kettle corn; being unique is what draws people in.

Best Practices for

Blog Posts: After identifying the target audience, you should design a blog post that will be easily accessible and appealing to that audience without alienating other customers. For example, a large portion of the people who buy from small businesses are young, and young people are interested in being health conscious. So, mentioning how the popcorn Poppin Joe's makes is healthier than store-bought alternatives because their fresh ingredients might draw in that crowd. However, the description shouldn't just be about how healthy Poppin Joe's products are. Visuals should be present. Clear calls to action should be employed, and a consistent posting schedule should be in place.

Website Content

- Use consistent, grammatically correct language
- Use keywords that make the website more recognizable to search engines
- Visuals with captions should be present
- Chunk and layer the text
- Have navigation tools
- Update the website for any promotions

Social Media Content

- **Consistently post every week**
- **Interact with consumers**
- **Include post about products and promotions with visuals**

- **Include Captions on every post**
- **Have moderated comments**

Past vs. Present vs. Future Tense

Past

When discussing the creation of Poppin Joe's, aka Joe's story, it should be told in the past tense.

Present

Flavors and promotions currently available should be discussed in the present tense.

Future

Flavors, promotions, and developments happening in the future should be discussed in the future tense.